

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 434

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Clifford Allan Brunger on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those extraordinary Tennesseans who, through their remarkable and exceptional efforts, have gone above and beyond the call of duty by dedicating their lives to protecting the citizens of this State and nation; and

WHEREAS, Clifford Allan Brunger is one such estimable individual, who has served the United States Navy and APM Group, Inc., with distinction and will embark upon his much-deserved retirement on June 12, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Brunger grew up in Fairview, where he and his brother fulfilled their household chores of transporting water from a nearby spring, cutting wood to heat the house, and milking their grandfather's cows for milk while enduring familial hardships at home; and

WHEREAS, it was because of these obstacles that Clifford Brunger began working at the age of fourteen, and during his high school career, he worked up to thirty hours each week while concurrently maintaining pristine grades in school and challenging his teachers to increase his workload; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Brunger graduated as Salutatorian of Fairview High School's Class of 1976 and then enlisted in the United States Navy, where he served as an electronics technician; and

WHEREAS, he attended Nuclear Power School in Orlando, Florida, and nuclear prototype training in Idaho Falls, Idaho, and, a year after his enlistment, Mr. Brunger was promoted to E5; he received his nuclear power operator designation in 1978; and

WHEREAS, after he completed Naval Academy Preparatory School, Clifford Brunger attended the United States Naval Academy in Annapolis, Maryland, graduating in 1984 with a degree in electrical engineering; and

WHEREAS, following flight school and service as a naval pilot and training flight instructor, Mr. Brunger was selected as an aeronautical duty officer and then selected for Naval Postgraduate School, earning his master's degree in aeronautical engineering in 1994; and

WHEREAS, his other positions within the Navy include service as an operational test director, an aircraft project engineer, and a lead for two programs with billion-dollar budgets; and

WHEREAS, in 2002, Mr. Brunger retired at the rank of Commander, following twenty-six years of distinguished service to the United States Navy; and

WHEREAS, that same year, he established APM Group, Inc., providing engineering services to the Department of Defense and analyzing naval contracts related to the manufacture of helicopters and planes, among other machinery; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Brunger has served APM Group, Inc., as president and chief financial officer for twenty-three years and will take his well-deserved retirement this year; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Brunger exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his illustrious career, Clifford Brunger has served these United States and the State of Tennessee with honor and distinction, and it is wholly fitting that he be recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and recognize Clifford Allan Brunger upon the occasion of his retirement, extend our gratitude for his many years of dutiful and valorous service, and offer our best wishes for his every future happiness and success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.